mashgin

EVALUATE · TRAIN · BUILD

The Art of Hiring

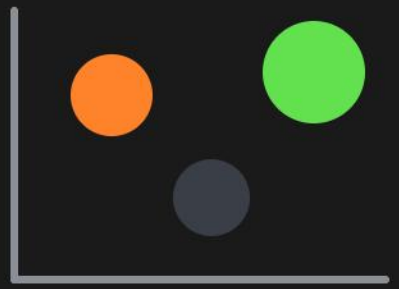
- Evaluating candidates [30 MIN]
- Training interviewers [30 MIN]
- Building the process [30 MIN]

mashgin

Every company interviews.
Few train their interviewers.

01 · EVALUATE

Strength × Fit



Who should we hire?

02 · TRAIN

Five levels



What makes an interviewer great?

03 · BUILD

3-stage process



How do we run it?

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

[ARC 2 · TRAINING INTERVIEWERS]

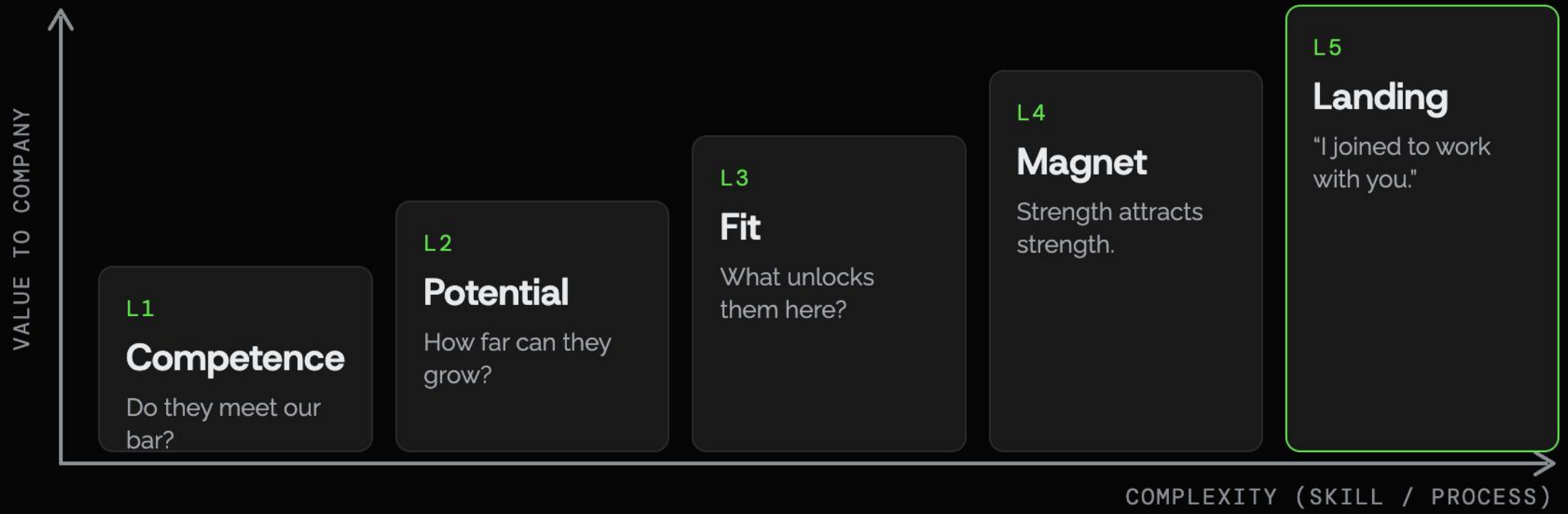
Your job: build the hiring machine.

As an EM, that means training your interviewers.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Five levels of an A-player interviewer.



Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

How the levels work.

01
Builds on the last
Higher levels build on lower ones.

02
Start anywhere
You don't need to master a level before working on the next.

03
Harder each step
Difficulty of mastery rises with each level.

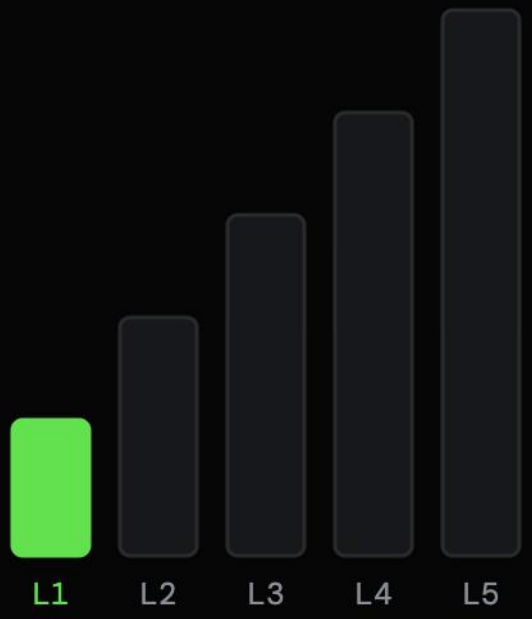
04
Taught on its own
Each level is trained independently.

05
Overlays the loop
Every stage of the interview process uses them.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Do they meet our technical bar?



Applied intelligence + technical competence.

GOOD	Finds valuable strengths using standard questions or problems.
BETTER	Changes style to fit the candidate: standard questions, interactive problem solving, or their past work.
BEST	Makes it look easy.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Senior isn't "knows what I know."

WRONG BAR

"Do they know what I know?"

Knowledge comes from experience. Yours and theirs aren't comparable.

RIGHT BAR

"What should they know, given their path?"

Read the résumé, then test what that experience should have taught them.

LOOK FOR

- Judgment
- Good questions
- Improvisation

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

[CASE STUDY]

Sanjay

[Co-Founder, Abnormal]

Goes deep, respectfully.

THE MOVE

Takes them to the ground in their own expertise.

THE INVITE

"Interview me. See how well I know this."

STEAL THIS

Depth they respect, without threat.

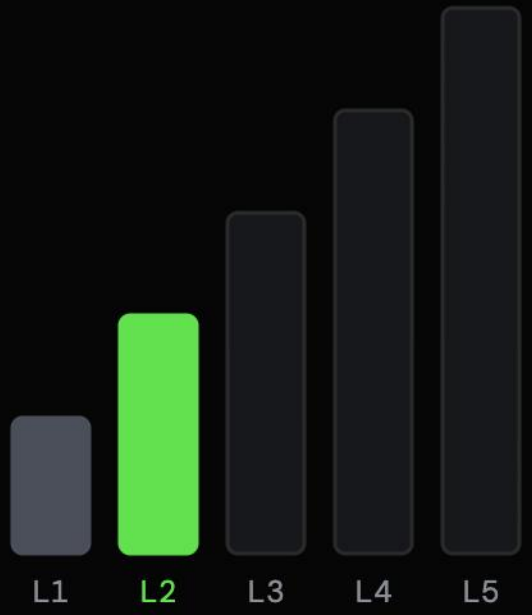
(Strength attracts strength.)



Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

What is their potential?



Interviewing for potential, not just today's skill.

GOOD	Finds repeated examples of high-potential behavior.
BETTER	Finds the limits: what are their blind spots?
BEST	Knows whether what unlocks their potential exists here.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

What does potential look like?

01
Motivation
A fierce commitment to excel in pursuit of unselfish goals.

02
Curiosity
Seeks new experiences, knowledge and candid feedback, to grow.

03
Insight
Gathers and makes sense of information that suggests new possibilities.

04
Engagement
Uses emotion and logic to communicate a persuasive vision and connect.

05
True Grit
Fights for difficult goals and bounces back from adversity.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

How do you test potential in a technical interview?

Ask the room. Capture answers live.

?

?

?

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

[CASE STUDY]

Steven

[Sr. Engineer, Mashgin]

Imagines them **already on his team.**



THE MOVE

Keep interview questions **open ended --** see where they go.

THE TELL

When the candidate expresses original thought & judgement

STEAL THIS

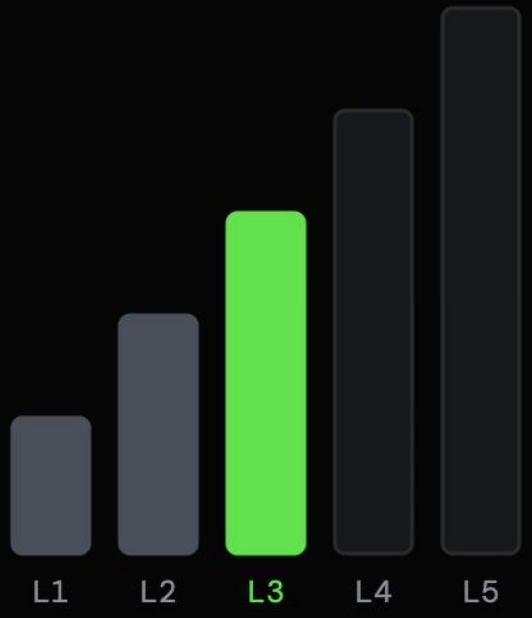
Show them we value curiousity and creativity.

("I'm incredibly biased toward raw talent")

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

What unlocks their potential HERE?



A mix of alignment, role requirements and cultural fit.

GOOD	Understands their goals, the environment they need and any culture issues, and believes all three work here.
BETTER	Can lay out a plan (projects, timing) that would unlock their potential here.
BEST	Shows how similar people executed that plan and got the results here.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Your problem is their opportunity.

FIRES FORGE PEOPLE

The hard team can be the growth role.

Show them the fire, eyes open. Wrong people run away; the right ones get excited.

BELIEVE IN THEM

Maybe no one ever did.

Explain why the job will be hard, and why **THEY** will succeed.

BE CONCRETE

Training starts in the interview.

Give feedback, show our onboarding process, discuss how they would solve **our problems.**

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

[CASE STUDY]

Joseph

[Sr. Dir of Engineering, MixPanel]

Tells the stories.

THE MOVE

Learns what motivates them.

THE PLAN

Shares how previous engineers succeeded.

STEAL THIS

Show them their future on **your** team.

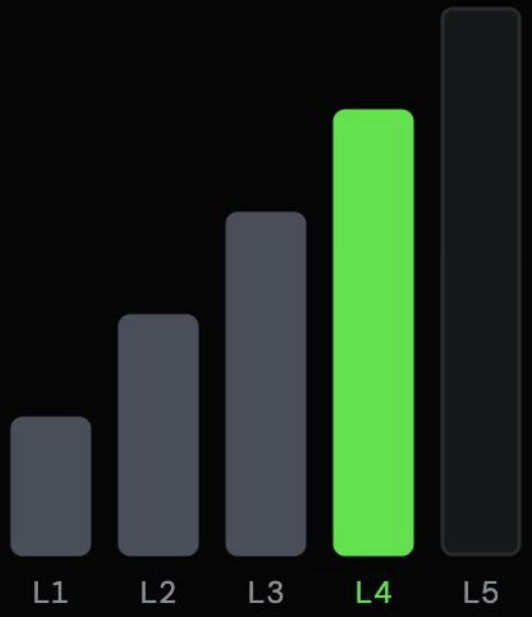
(our on-boarding plans come from him...)



Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

How do you attract talent?



Pro tip: you don't sell them.

GOOD	Shows agility and depth in areas the candidate values. Strength attracts strength.
BETTER	Impresses them: clearly better, without threat, where they want to grow.
BEST	Shows how you personally can grow them, in a way they value.

(No humble brags: be comfortable in your strengths and honest in your weaknesses.)

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Strength attracts strength.

A PLAYERS	Want to work for leaders stronger than themselves.
B PLAYERS	Feel uncomfortable around A players.
C PLAYERS	Can't tell the difference between an A and a C.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

[CASE STUDY]

John

[Staff Vision Engineer, Doxel]

Bring on the challenge.



THE MOVE

Discusses HIS unsolved, **hard** problems.

THE EFFECT

"I'll learn so much from John."

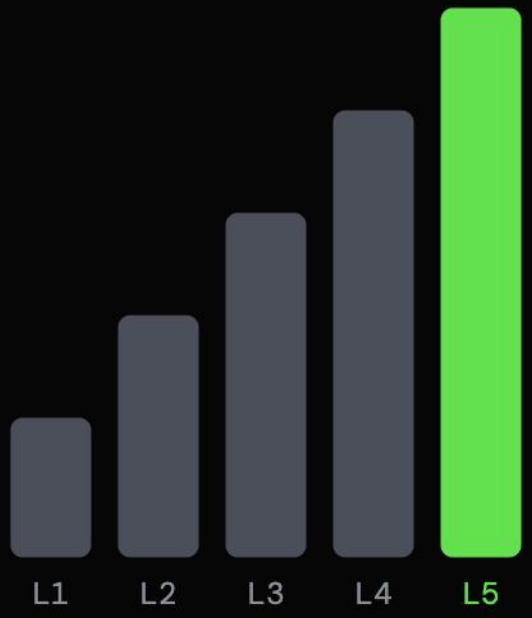
STEAL THIS

Interview on the real work, not hypotheticals.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

How do you land 10× talent?



If it's about the compensation, you've already lost.

GOOD	Connects with the candidate deeply, in a way that matters to them.
BETTER	Pitches the role, team and company with emotional impact.
BEST	Shows why they would win here vs. other options, and it resonates.

(We only live once & work is a LOT of hours — show them your AWESOME self)

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

“I joined this company to work with you.”

When you start hearing this, you’re at L5.

People decide with emotion, then find the reasons. Emotion is high-order computation.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

[CASE STUDY]

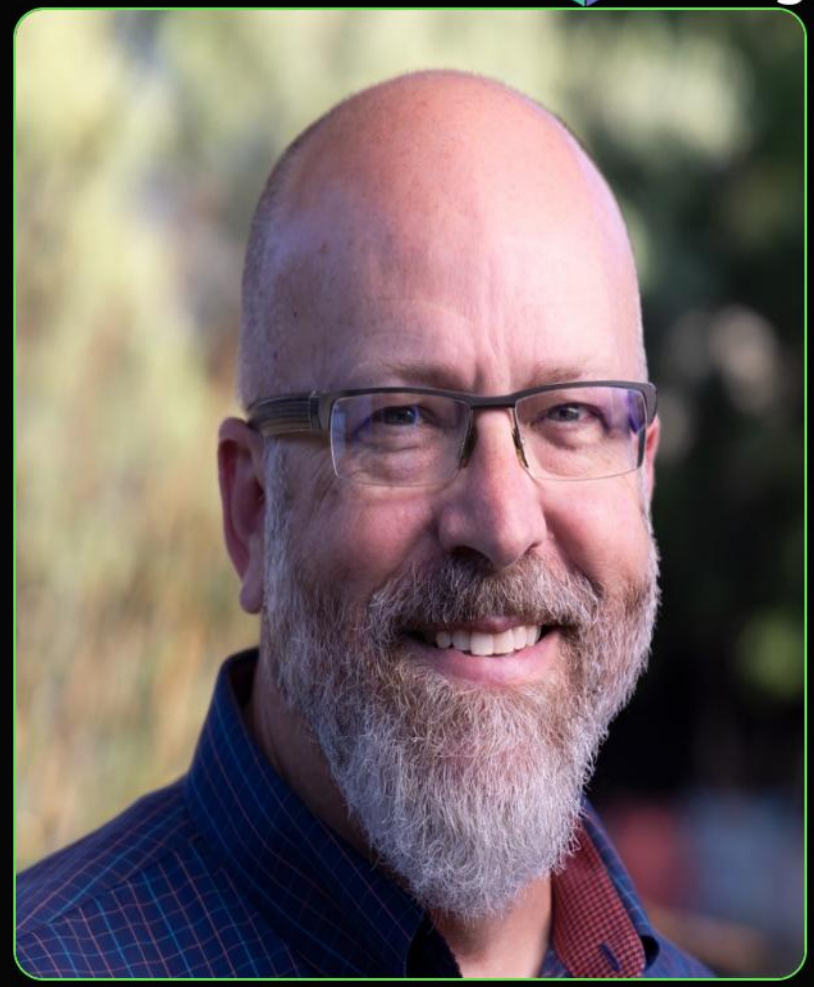
Wade

[CTO, Amplitude]

The Guru.

THE MOVE	THE EFFECT	STEAL THIS
Finds the emotional strings unique to you.	Plucks them. You can't ignore it.	Learn what moves them, then speak to it.

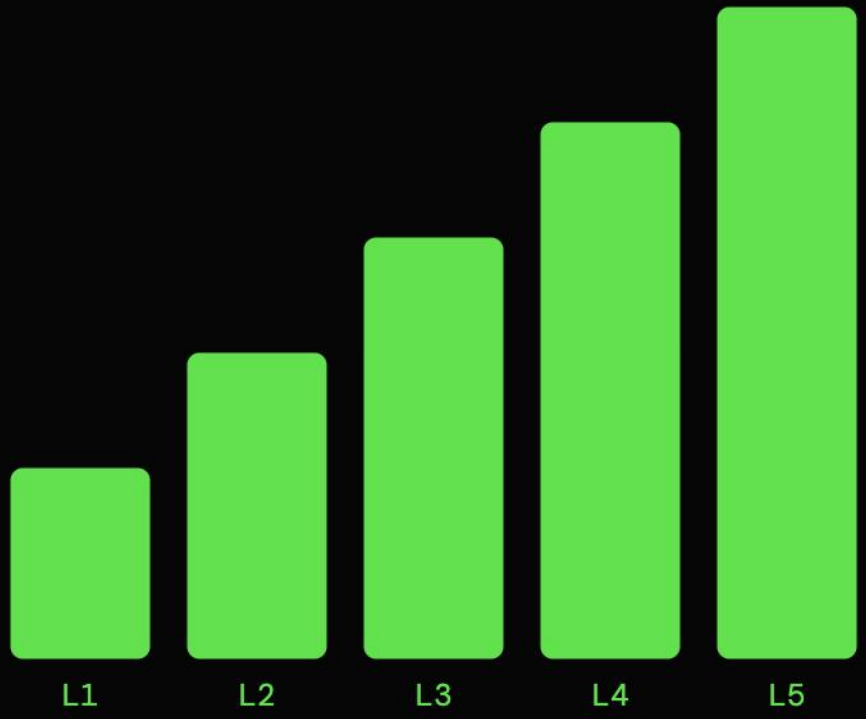
(Show them the path that lies ahead — and how you'll help them navigate it.)



Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

All five: an A-player interviewer.



L1 **Competence** · Do they meet our bar?

L2 **Potential** · How far can they grow?

L3 **Fit** · What unlocks them here?

L4 **Magnet** · Strength attracts strength.

L5 **Landing** · "I joined to work with you."

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Be interested.

RESPONSIBILITY

Connection
No distractions
(Turn off Slack and Claude!)

LOOK FOR

Motivation
Pride
Why they left

EMPLOY

Active listening
“Tell me more?”

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Be an advocate.

	GOOD FOR US	BAD FOR US
GOOD FOR THEM	**Great employee.**	They get fired when we figure it out.
BAD FOR THEM	They leave when they figure it out, or stay for the wrong reason.	Nobody wins.

Fit is established **jointly**.

FOR THEM

Is this the right next stage of their career? What do they want, and how will they prioritize?

DON'T GO NATIVE

You represent the company. Every candidate leaves an evangelist.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Be someone they want to work with.

- Park your ego
- Be genuine
- Be aware
- Be a gracious host
- Be excited
- Be interested
- Be wicked smart
- Ask insightful questions
- Ask hard questions
- Be helpful

They're interviewing you, too.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026

mashgin

Five levels, how to do each.

L1	**Competence**	Adapt to the candidate: standard questions, live problems, or their past work.
L2	**Potential**	Find repeated high-potential behavior, then probe for the blind spots.
L3	**Fit**	Lay out the plan, projects and timing, that unlocks them here.
L4	**Magnet**	Interview on the real work, and show how you'll grow them.
L5	**Landing**	Find what moves them, and show them the path ahead.

Copyright Dobromir Montauk, 2026